

SAMPLE ACES Proposal Submission Outline

Menu Choices are Listed in Parentheses. All character maximums include spaces. *Denotes required question

Author's Details

Lead Presenter Information (will be the contact person as well as first author)

- *Title (Dr., Ms., Mr.): Mr.
- *First Name: Raymond
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- *Highest Degree Earned (PhD, EdD, **Master's Degree**, Bachelor's Degree)
- *Area of Study for Highest Degree Earned: Clinical Mental Health Counseling
- *Credentials (e.g., licenses and certifications) If none, please indicate NA in the box provided.
Character Maximum: 250: Licensed Professional Counselor in the State of Arkansas
- *Are you currently enrolled in a doctoral program? Yes
- *Current Professional Role. Please select one role that best characterizes your main work role.
(Counselor Educator, Supervisor, Counselor, Student): Counselor Educator

Submission Details

***Program Title**

Attachment Style Awareness in the Supervisory Relationship

***What type of submission is this proposal?** (50-minute education session OR 30-minute poster): 50 Minute Session

***If your proposal is not accepted for the submission type you chose above, are you willing to present it in a different format? Check all that apply.** (**Yes, I am willing to present an education session. I am willing to present a poster.** No, I am not willing to present this proposal in another format.)

***If the focus of your session is any of the following, please check as many appropriate boxes as apply to your session. If none apply, please select, "Not Applicable."**
(Ethics, Pedagogy, Research, **Supervision**, Antiracist Practices in Counselor Education)

***Please select the topic area(s) that best describes your proposal as it relates to counselor education and/or supervision (select up to two).** (Assessment, Career Development and

Counseling, **Counseling Theory/Practice and the Counseling Relationship**, Counselor Professional Identity and Practice Issues, Group Dynamics and Counseling, Human Growth and Development, Research and Program Evaluation, Social and Cultural Foundations, **Wellness and Prevention**)

***Learning Objective 1** (Character Maximum: 300):

Participants will become familiar with how an attachment style predicts helpful relationships.

***Learning Objective 2** (Character Maximum: 300):

Participants will explore their own attachment style and the relationship between their supervisees and their awareness of this style.

***Learning Objective 3** (Character Maximum: 300)

Participants will examine the level of personal and counselor in training well-being as affected by attachment theory.

***Program Summary for Publication in Conference Program**

Character Maximum: 850:

Every counselor educator and supervisor is passionate about developing and maintaining the health of counselors in training. The current models of supervision are proven tools for directing this development. Many newer models have shifted from training future counselors to utilize the skills of counseling to teaching awareness of self. The goal of these new models is to allow counselors in training to build alliances, counteract countertransference, and allow clients to change through interpersonal theories of psychotherapy. When Bowlby's attachment theory is adapted to adult attachment theory and relational psychology in the supervisory relationship, these goals become clearer. This presentation will provide educational content for attachment theory as related to supervision, allow participants to grow in awareness of their own attachment style with counselors in training, and build healthier relationships while maintaining the mental well-being of themselves and CITs.

***Program Description (Please include rationale, program goals, and delivery method. All presentations, particularly those related to teaching or supervision client diagnosis, evaluation, or treatment, must provide evidence that the information presented is clinically sound and in accordance with accepted professional practice, ethical guidelines, and current research. A space for references is provided in the next question. Character Maximum: 3000:**

Many supervisors have been taught programmatic and linear models of supervision. While these directive and transactional models are proven forms of ensuring skills acquisition for counselors in training (CIT), they can be contradictory to the nature of counseling and the desire of supervisors and CITs. The nature of counseling is relational, not transactional. The desire of many supervisors and CITs is to bring healing through healthy relationships. As many who enter these supervisory relationships may not be aware of a model that aligns with their goals and values, I will be presenting the alternative to the former models of supervision. This relational model will give supervisors methods and theories utilizing attachment theories concepts of secure base and safe-haven to provide supervision more in line with their philosophy of counseling.

In addition to providing theory, the author intends to share assessments for discovering one's attachment style, one's level of burnout, and how one's supervision outcomes can change. Utilizing the assessments recommended in this presentation, participants will leave with a nominal understanding of their own attachment profile. This presentation will be a 50-minute technology-assisted lecture with interactive elements, questions for the participants, and discussion opportunities for all. The model presented will be based on the research below and is proven to be an effective method of supervision based on independent clinical trials and peer-reviewed literature. The design of the presentation is expected to invoke excitement for an alternative way of developing CITs and a proven mode of maintaining personal well-being and promoting CIT well-being.

References cited in your -minute technology-.

Characters Maximum: 10000:

Mammen, M. A. (2020). Attachment dynamics in the supervisory relationship: Becoming your own good supervisor. *Journal of Psychotherapy Integration*, 30(1), 93–101. <https://doi.org/10.1037/int0000164>

Fitch, J., Pistole, M. C., & Gunn, J. (2010). The bonds of development: an Attachment-caregiving model of supervision. *Clinical Supervisor*, 29(1), 20–34. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07325221003730319>

Hiebler, R. M., Nausner, L., Blaha, A., Grimmer, K., Korlath, S., Mernyi, M., & Unterrainer, H. F. (2021). The supervisory relationship from an attachment perspective: Connections to burnout and sense of coherence in health professionals. *Clinical Psychology & Psychotherapy*, 28(1), 124–136. <https://doi.org/10.1002/cpp.2494>

***Discuss the evidence/research base for your presentation, and whether you are presenting original research.**

Character Maximum: 3000:

The research for this proposal comes from a meta-analysis of the extant body of literature with regard to attachment theory and its mediating and moderating effects on supervision. The research presented in this proposal is not original to the author but a collection of the research from various journals.

According to the research underwriting this proposal, Bowlby's attachment theory indicates that early experiences with parents shape our view of ourselves and others (Mammen, 2020). Not dissimilar to this concept, some supervision models have theorized and formulated interventions based on an apparent shaping of counselors in training through an attachment frame with their supervisors (Mammen, 2020). Fitch et al. (2010) state that we have ignored the relational aspect of the supervisor/supervisee dyad for far too long and that the dynamics of the relationship matter as much as skills acquisition for counselors in training development. According to the model proposed by Fitch et al., when a supervisor provides a safe-haven and a secure base for counselors in training, they thrive in the safe environment and learn important awareness of their own reactions to future clients.

Of additional concern for this presentation is the research that outlines a supervisors relationship with the supervisee can moderate the supervisee's sense of well-being during development (Hiebler et al., 2021). The sense of coherence potentially built through an

awareness of attachment styles and considerations also moderates the well-being of the counselor in training (Hiebler et al., 2021).

All of these findings support the author's desire to encourage supervisors to diligently attend to and become aware of their own attachment style and the attachment styles of counselors in training to both shape their ability to build consistent therapeutic alliance and guard against burnout.

***Please discuss how your proposal aligns with counselor education and/or supervision.**

Character Maximum: 2500:

This proposal directly relates to the pragmatic elements of supervision and the supervision relationship. Attachment theory is a proven concept over time and is increasingly becoming a part of emerging theories of change. The supervisory relationship is said to be similar to the relationship with a parent and therefore has similar implications through attachment theory. As supervisors understand their own attachment style (particularly with counselors in training), they will be better equipped to understand where their own reactions to counselors in training (CIT) and clients arise from. As they are better equipped to understand this, they will be better equipped to develop CITs who do the same. The experience of a secure base and a safe-haven is key to developing a therapeutic alliance and maintaining emotional well-being in our field. Supervisors are in need of concepts and training that encourage and allow them to persist in these goals. This presentation will offer supervisors those concepts and encouragement.

***Please discuss the expertise of the presenters and explain why they are qualified to make the proposed presentation. Do not include any identifying details.**

Character Maximum: 2500:

***Which of the following will you utilize during your presentation?** If you are applying for a poster, please check "does not apply." (Case Study, Role-Play, Participant Discussion, **Lecture**, **Experimental/Active Learning**, **Multimedia PowerPoint**/Keynote, etc., Handouts, Does not apply)

***Who is your target audience for your proposal?** Check all that apply. (**Counselor Educators**, **Supervisors**, **Graduate Students**)